

Hebron Community Center

Executive Summary

Client

Jennifer Balkey, Executive Director

Student Consulting Team

Skylar Arce

Katie Makarska

Rathi Murugan

Background

Hebron Community Center (HCC) is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit located in Penn Hills, Pennsylvania, serving the community through fitness, wellness, and youth programs. Founded in 2021 and led by Executive Director Jennifer Balkey, HCC sees approximately 250 participants per month across activities including Zumba, Basketball, Volleyball, and Soccer/Futsal. The organization runs on Zoho One, using an iPad kiosk for participant check-in and a small volunteer committee to support operations.

Project Description

Project Opportunity

HCC's GetFit check-in system lacked any structured payment capture. Revenue was verified manually by Jen via her phone during check-in and tracked across Zoho Finance, a manual P&L spreadsheet, and peer-to-peer payment apps with no consistent connection to participant records. Duplicate member records accumulated because the waiver submission workflow had no deduplication logic and no confirmation page, causing participants to resubmit repeatedly. Monthly revenue reporting required 30 to 45 minutes of manual reconciliation per cycle with medium-to-high accuracy risk, and total administrative burden across revenue, attendance, and instructor compensation was estimated at 65 to 100 minutes per reporting cycle.

Project Vision

The team rebuilt the GetFit check-in flow end-to-end in Zoho Creator and created the CRM infrastructure needed to capture payment data automatically at point of check-in. The original project scope was dashboard and reporting optimization; mid-project investigation revealed the underlying data capture infrastructure had to be built first. With client approval, scope shifted accordingly, with dashboard development positioned as the natural next phase. Alternatives including platform migration and custom development were ruled out due to cost and timeline constraints.

Project Outcomes

The core deliverable is a fully rebuilt six-screen check-in and payment processing flow deployed to HCC's production Zoho environment on April 16, 2026.

People: Staff no longer verify payments manually during check-in. Returning participants with valid waivers are automatically routed past the waiver step. Three CMU IS participants completed the full flow in person with a 100% success rate in 42 to 57 seconds. Client testing with Jen was conducted virtually.

Process: Participant lookup, waiver routing, deduplication, activity selection, payment confirmation, and CRM record creation now follow a single enforced path. Duplicate waiver submissions are automatically blocked via Deluge validation. Activities populate dynamically from the GetFit Activities CRM module filtered by day of week.

Technology: A new GetFit Payments CRM module stores structured payment records linked to Members and GetFit Activities. Historical payment data was normalized and imported. A bonus mass email notification feature enables Jen to reach all participants in a given program at once.

Project Deliverables

- Rebuilt GetFit check-in and payment application deployed to Zoho Creator Production
- GetFit Payments CRM module with full field configuration and historical data imported
- Updated GetFit Activities CRM module with dynamic day-of-week filtering
- 14-page handoff documentation serving as both a staff guide and technical manual for future developers
- Technical documentation package including workflow diagrams, architecture notes, and deployment plan
- Mass email notification feature for participant communications

Recommendations

- Build Zoho Analytics dashboards using the GetFit Payments module, targeting monthly revenue, revenue by activity, and instructor compensation views
- Implement membership tracking logic to automatically bypass payment for participants with active monthly memberships
- Run quarterly deduplication reviews in Zoho CRM and set email as a required registration field
- Replace the facility QR code with one pointing to the Participant Check-in Start page rather than the Adult Waiver form
- Brief staff on the new six-screen flow before live use to ensure consistent data capture

Student Consulting Team

Skylar Arce ('27) served as the Client Relationship Lead. She is a junior at Carnegie Mellon University majoring in Information Systems. She is interested in pursuing a career in product management after graduation.

Katie Makarska ('26) served as the Project Manager and led handoff documentation. She is a senior at Carnegie Mellon University majoring in Information Systems and will be joining Surge AI full-time as a Product Manager after graduation.

Rathi Murugan ('26) served as the Technical Lead. She is a senior at Carnegie Mellon University majoring in Information Systems and will be pursuing her Master's degree after graduation.